MOHAN YADAV
Chief Minister, Madhya Pradesh

THE GROWTH STIMULANT

Madhya Pradesh has nothing to worry about on the finance front despite the new cash-heavy welfare programmes announced before the assembly poll, such as Ladli Behna. This emphatic statement came from none other than Mohan Yadav, the newly-appointed Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh, at the India Today Conclave. Reiterating that the finances of the state were in order and it had not even resorted to an overdraft, the CM said growth in Madhya Pradesh was being recorded in every sector, including agriculture and manufacturing.

A little more than three months into his job, the selection for which—by his own admission—came as a surprise to him initially, Yadav spelt out what he intended to do for the state in agriculture. The MLA from Ujjain South said his appointment as CM was a reaffirmation of the BJP's politics, which enables even a simple worker to attain the highest political office in the state. He refuted the argument that he had been chosen only because he was a Yadav and the party wanted to use him in the Hindi belt to pull in the vote of his community.

On the inclusion of Congress leaders in the BJP, Yadav stated that the Grand Old Party was in disarray, it was seeing mass desertions, so much so that the BJP had to keep the entry of some of the ex-Congress leaders on hold. ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Madhya Pradesh's agriculture sector is growing at 25%, the fastest among all states and the industrial growth rate is 24%. The state's contribution to the national GDP is 4.5% and is to be doubled. The state has not taken an overdraft**
- **MP was one of the first states to implement the National Education Policy**
- **The Narmada Valley Development Authority has expanded the irrigation potential to Malwa, Nimar and Mahakoshal regions**



"ALL OUR PARTY WORKERS ARE PREPARED FOR ELECTIONS AT ALL TIMES. WE WILL WIN ALL 29 SEATS, INCLUDING CHHINDWARA, UNDER THE LEADERSHIP OF PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA MODIJI. LAST TIME, THE CONGRESS'S VICTORY MARGIN WAS REDUCED TO AROUND 40,000 VOTES. WITH MANY CONGRESSMEN IN CHHINDWARA JOINING THE BJP, WE ARE CONFIDENT OF WINNING ALL SEATS THIS TIME"

"The BJP rewards any worker who is hard-working and has the potential to work for the country. I am a case in point. I do not have a corporator or MLA in my family. I have worked as a farmer; I have run a hotel. The BJP does not look at caste"

Photographs by BANDEEP SINGH